DRAFT

Severe Bleeding Response

A quick reminder after recognized STOP THE BLEED® or equivalent instructor-led training—not a substitute for hands-on practice.

✕ DANGER — STOP NOW

Life-threatening bleeding is an emergency. Call 911 or your local emergency number now. Do not delay emergency activation to read this handout. Follow the dispatcher's instructions.

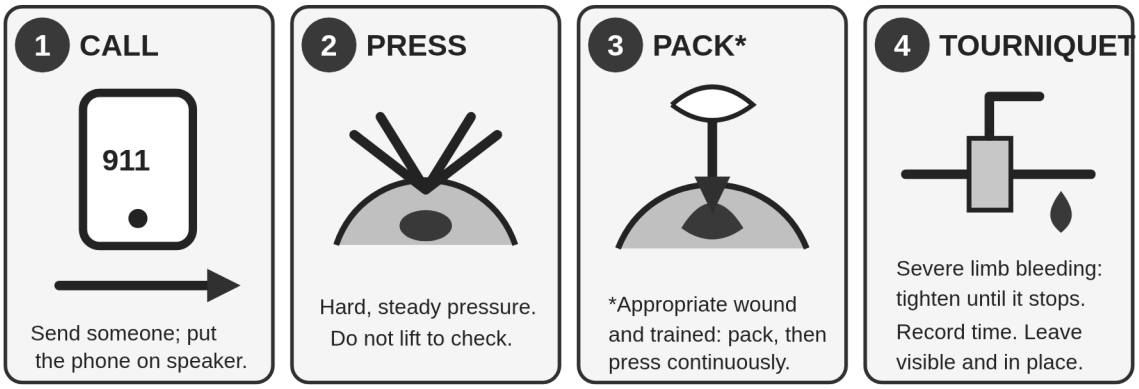
△ CAUTION — PREVENT HARM

DRAFT—DO NOT DISTRIBUTE FOR USE. A clinician or certified bleeding-control instructor must review the words and diagram before this handout moves beyond draft.

RECOGNIZE AND ACT

Suspect life-threatening bleeding when blood flows continuously or spurts, pools on the ground, soaks clothing or bandages, or when the person shows shock or confusion. Act immediately.

1. **Make the scene safe.** Do not enter traffic, fire, violence, electrical, structural, or other danger. Use disposable gloves and eye protection when available; do not delay lifesaving pressure if barriers are unavailable.
2. **Activate help.** Call emergency services, or point to a person and tell them to call and bring a bleeding-control kit. Put the phone on speaker if you are alone.
3. **Find and expose the injury.** Remove or cut clothing only as needed to see where blood is coming from. Check for more than one wound while protecting the person from cold.
4. **Press continuously.** Place gauze or a clean dressing directly on the bleeding site. Push hard with both hands and hold steady until bleeding stops or responders take over. Do not lift the dressing to check; add material on top if needed.



Call → press → pack if trained → tourniquet for a severely bleeding limb. The sequence follows medically reviewed American College of Surgeons STOP THE BLEED training resources; this local adaptation still requires clinician or certified-instructor review.

SKL-007

Severe Bleeding Response — continued

IF DIRECT PRESSURE DOES NOT CONTROL IT

Pack an appropriate wound—only if trained

For a deep wound where a tourniquet cannot be used, such as the groin, armpit, shoulder, or neck, tightly pack bleeding-control gauze into the wound to the bleeding source, then press hard and continuously. Use hemostatic gauze if your training and product directions support it; otherwise use gauze from the bleeding-control kit. **Do not pack the chest, abdomen, or an eye.** Do not remove packing.

Use a commercial tourniquet for severe arm or leg bleeding

1. Place a recognized **commercial tourniquet** 2–3 inches (5–8 cm) above the bleeding wound, between the wound and torso. Do not place it over the wound or a joint. If the wound cannot be located quickly, place it high and tight on the limb.
2. Pull the strap tight and fasten it. Twist the windlass until bleeding stops, then secure the windlass. It will hurt. If bleeding continues, tighten further or apply a second commercial tourniquet above the first if available and you are trained.
3. Write the application time below and on the tourniquet if it has a time field. Keep it uncovered and visible. Stay with the person, keep them warm, and monitor breathing until responders arrive.

× DANGER — STOP NOW

Never remove an embedded object or probe a wound. Apply pressure around an embedded object. **Never** loosen, remove, or conceal an applied tourniquet; only emergency or medical professionals should remove it.

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Equipment boundary: This handout recommends a recognized commercial tourniquet and purpose-made bleeding-control gauze. It does not teach or recommend improvised tourniquets or improvised wound-packing material.

RECORD AND HAND OVER

Responder information	Record
Tourniquet application time (include a.m./p.m.)	_____ : _____ a.m. / p.m.
Tourniquet location / number applied	_____
Other care given and changes observed	_____ _____
Care handed to (agency / responder)	_____
Handoff date and time	_____ _____ : _____

Tell responders: where every wound is; when each tourniquet was applied; whether the wound was packed; what products were used; and any changes in breathing, alertness, or bleeding.

SOURCES

American College of Surgeons, *STOP THE BLEED Resources—Posters and Booklet* and *STOP THE BLEED Online Training*: www.stopthebleed.org/resources-poster-booklet/ and www.stopthebleed.org/training/online-course/. Accessed 2026-09-29.